

INTRODUCTION

Not long ago I had someone call to ask a question about a comment I had made on a seminar tape. I was about to explain it when she said, "Wait just a minute. Would you mind explaining that to my daughter, because she's been listening to your tapes and it's her question?" The daughter was eight years old. She asked a question about borrowing and whether or not it was scriptural.

I was astounded. I had forgotten that many times young children can understand a great deal more than we give them credit for. Usually their attitudes are formed at an early age. They're either formed in the image of God or in the image of the world. Christian parents have the responsibility to help form their children into the image of God.

Remember what God told Eli? He said that Eli's sons had done evil in the sight of the Lord, and He was going to punish them for it. In fact, He took their lives. And God told Eli that he must also die, not for their sins but because he did not train them in the ways of the Lord. Eli was not responsible for his sons' decisions. He was responsible for their training (1 Samuel 2:27-34).

A simple biblical principle will greatly help our children: "In the face of the truth, a lie will always be evident." Therefore, what you need to do as a parent is expose your children to the truth of God's Word, and it will reveal the lies they're going to hear about finances. It's interesting how banks train tellers to recognize counterfeit bills. They don't keep a supply of counterfeit bills to show them. Instead they sit them down with a stack of brand-new \$20 bills and let them thumb through good 20s. Once they have done that long enough, they'll recognize a counterfeit when it crosses their hands, just by the feel. Once they know the real thing, the phonies will be evident.

I would like to share some simple principles of teaching children about finances that have been helpful to us and many